

Digit 101

To know what are the different smartphone sensors and how they're used, read this month's Digit 101

**Blaster Sold**

Han Solo's blaster from the movies gets sold online for \$200,000. Read on to know more. <http://digit.in/5o1oblaster>



Newton antique from 1993 blabbering to anyone who'll listen that Newton suffered the slings and arrows of misfortune and could've been the father of smartphones. There, there, we feel your pain. But Apple's ambitious mobile PDA-like device failed to either deliver the portability, battery life, handwriting recognition and value that it was supposed to for the jet setting age of pre-bubble IT-land. It got usurped by Microsoft and Palm's PDAs and Apple bowed out of the scene. Until the iPhone revolution. So it got the last laugh. But the Newton still sucks. Sorry Expo dude.

5 Sirius XM (2001)

The Sirius XM satellite radio was uber-cool when it first launched in 2001. Over a hundred stations, portable and commercial free music was a god sent. The consumers loved it and subscribers rose year over year as the company fell deeper and deeper in debt to keep it all running. In its attempt to capture market share, hundreds of millions were spent



on marketing, operations and other expenses, just waiting for the right time to start raking in that sweet, sweet revenue. But during the slow moving decisions of corporate hobnobbing, the Apple iPod came out. It was all over as users realised they could now carry their personalized music library with them without having to rely on old fashioned radio to play their favourite tracks. Within months the company started crumbling and all the dreams of revenue crumbled with them.

6 Myspace (2003)

How can anything that is led by the mighty creative vision of Justin Timberlake suck, right? (insert sarcasm here). But that was after the crash and burn you say? But even then Myspace is kind of useless. Starting out in 2003 as THE social networking site, Myspace enjoyed its time in the sun right up till the moment



Facebook launched and it was all over. Within months users realised the horrible user interface, design and experience of Myspace and left. And in under a year Myspace dried up to half its size. It kept leaning up until Timberlake came on board and confused its rebranding completely, leading reviewers to actually come up with a suggestion - "Just Die Already". We think they meant My Space, not Timberlake. We think.

7 Microsoft Zune (2006)

It's hard not to giggle about the Zune. Seriously. Microsoft had to work really hard to screw up the Zune - despite having major music labels, major hardware R&D resources and massive coffers for marketing - Microsoft wasn't able to design and deliver a music player system without heap loads of glitches, clunky online store interface and major design turnoffs. Since



its late 2006 release the Zune has only taken about 1 percent of the MP3 player market share while Apple continues to dominate with a near 80 percent advantage. And even though the Zune hardware player is no longer manufactured, sold or supported, Zune finds itself disembodied as a software music service across the Microsoft ecosystem. Tread lightly. You've been warned.

8 TwitterPeek (2009)

The interweb is a weird place filled with fake ads, fake people and fake news. So in 2009, when we heard about a gadget that's supposed to be used exclusively for Twitter, we took it with a pinch of salt. But dang it! We were wrong. TwitterPeek is real. A pocket sized mutant love child of a colour LCD pager and a QWERTY keyboard, TwitterPeek could allegedly read, post and display tweets. That's it. Sold for about USD \$200 with a monthly subscription cost for data services, the device didn't really find its customers (because asylums don't allow Tweeting, although they should). The TwitterPeek couldn't even display the 140 character tweets fully and displayed images only from

